PLAYER 2 LEVEL UP · POLICY

# SAFER RECRUITMENT POLICY

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| POLICY OWNER | Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up |
| SAFEGUARDING LEAD | Rory Horseman |
| DATE ADOPTED | 11 November 2026 |
| NEXT REVIEW | 11 November 2027 |

## 1. OUR COMMITMENT

Player 2 Level Up is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of the children and young people in our community. Safer recruitment helps us deter, identify and reject people who may be unsuitable to work with children.

This policy applies to anyone who works with young people on behalf of Player 2 Level Up, including employees, contractors, mentors, Discord moderators and volunteers, whether paid or unpaid.

We follow the Department for Education's guidance, Keeping children safe during community activities, after-school clubs and tuition, together with Working Together to Safeguard Children and the Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) guidance.

## 2. PLANNING A ROLE

Before recruiting, we will:

- Write a clear role description, including the safeguarding responsibilities of the role.
- Set out the skills, experience and qualities needed.
- Decide which level of DBS check the role is eligible for.
- Make clear in any advert that we are committed to safeguarding and that the role is subject to checks, including a DBS check.

## 3. APPLICATIONS

- Everyone applying must complete an application form. A CV on its own is not enough.
- Applicants must explain any gaps in their employment or education history.
- Applicants must complete a self-declaration about any criminal record or other information that could affect their suitability, in line with the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974 and DBS filtering rules.
- Applicants must tell us if they are barred from working with children.

## 4. SHORTLISTING AND INTERVIEWS

- Applications are checked carefully, including any gaps or inconsistencies.
- Interviews include questions about safeguarding, professional boundaries and the person's reasons for wanting to work with young people.
- Where possible, at least one interviewer will have completed safer recruitment training.

- Interviews may take place by video call. Identity is always confirmed before a person starts work.
- We may look at publicly available information online about shortlisted candidates. Candidates will be told that we do this.

## 5. CHECKS BEFORE STARTING

No one will work with young people until all of the following checks are complete and satisfactory:

- **Identity:** proof of identity, checked against the person's documents.
- **Right to work:** confirmation of the right to work in the UK, for paid roles.
- **References:** two references, one from the most recent employer or from a role involving children where possible. References are requested before the start date and checked with the referee.
- **DBS check:** an Enhanced DBS check with a Children's Barred List check where the role is regulated activity with children, or otherwise the highest level of check the role is eligible for.
- **Overseas checks:** where the person has lived or worked outside the UK.
- **Qualifications:** evidence of any qualifications the role requires.
- **Policies:** a signed confirmation that the person has read and will follow our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy, Online Safety Policy and Staff Code of Conduct.

Since 1 September 2026, the supervision exemption no longer applies to regulated activity with children. Roles that were previously outside regulated activity only because the person was supervised may now be eligible for a Children's Barred List check. We will check each role against current DBS guidance.

The owner, Rory Horseman, will hold an Enhanced DBS check with a Children's Barred List check where eligible, and keep it up to date. Self-employed people can apply for this through a registered DBS umbrella body.

## 6. INDUCTION AND PROBATION

- Everyone completes a safeguarding induction before working with young people, covering how to recognise, respond to and report concerns.
- The induction includes our online safety procedures and how to use the Discord moderation tools.
- Safeguarding training is refreshed at least every two years, with regular updates in between.
- New starters complete a probation period of three months, with regular check-ins and supervision.

## 7. KEEPING RECORDS

- We keep a record of the checks completed for each person, including the date, the type of check, the DBS certificate number and who carried out the check.
- We do not keep copies of DBS certificates for longer than necessary, and normally for no more than six months, in line with the DBS code of practice.

- Records about unsuccessful applicants are kept for six months and then securely deleted.
- All recruitment information is handled in line with our Data Protection Policy.

## 8. ONGOING SUITABILITY

- DBS checks are renewed every three years, or kept up to date through the DBS Update Service.
- Everyone must tell Rory Horseman straight away about any arrest, charge, caution or conviction, or anything else that could affect their suitability to work with children.
- Concerns about anyone working with young people are handled under our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy and Staff Code of Conduct, and referred to the Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO) where required.
- Where someone is removed from working with children because they have harmed a child or posed a risk of harm, we will make a referral to the DBS, as the law requires.

## 9. POLICY REVIEW

This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if the law, guidance or the way we work changes.

It should be read alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy, Staff Code of Conduct, Online Safety Policy and Data Protection Policy.

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Approved by Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up, on 11 November 2026. Next review due 11 November 2027.